

GALLANT IAS ACADEMY
PRELIMS CUM MAINS BATCH 2027
POLITY
MODULE 2.6

PARLIAMENT - DEVICES OF PARLIAMENTARY PROCEEDINGS

Question Hour

Question Hour is the **first hour** of a sitting of the House, during which members ask questions of Ministers on matters of administration. There are three types of questions.

Type of Question	Features
Starred	Requires an oral answer, which may be followed by supplementary questions; distinguished by an asterisk (*) mark
Unstarred	Requires a written answer; no supplementary questions can follow
Short Notice	Relates to a matter of urgent public importance; can be asked with notice of 10 days

Zero Hour

Zero Hour is not mentioned in the Rules of Procedure and requires no prior notice. It takes place after Question Hour and is regarded as an Indian innovation in parliamentary procedure.

Motions

A **Substantive Motion** is a self-contained, independent motion capable of expressing a decision of the House on its own - for example, a No-Confidence Motion. A **Substitute Motion** is one moved as a substitute for the original motion. A **Subsidiary Motion** is one that is based on, and depends for its meaning upon, another motion.

Types of Subsidiary Motion

Type	Description
Ancillary Motion	A different proceeding for the bill is suggested
Superseding Motion	Supersedes the subject under discussion and takes up another issue instead
Amendment Motion	Seeks to modify the original motion

Closure Motion

A Closure Motion is a motion to cut short a debate. There are four kinds:

Kind	Description
Simple Closure	A member moves that the matter, having been sufficiently discussed, be now put to vote (the entire bill is debated and discussed)
Closure by Compartments	The clauses of a bill or a lengthy resolution are grouped into parts before the debate begins; the debate covers each part as a whole, and the entire part is then put to vote
Kangaroo Closure	Only the important parts are debated and voted upon; the remaining parts are deemed to be passed
Guillotine	When the allotted time is over, undiscussed matter is clubbed together with discussed matter and put to vote

Privilege Motion

A Privilege Motion is moved to censure the concerned member for a breach of privilege.

Adjournment Motion

- Can be moved only in the **Lok Sabha**
- Needs the support of **50 members**
- Used to draw the attention of the House to a matter of public importance
- Only a single matter can be taken up
- Matters of privilege should not be raised
- A sub judice matter should not be discussed

No-Confidence Motion

- For the maintenance of **Article 75** (collective responsibility of the Council of Ministers to the Lok Sabha)
- Needs the support of **50 members**
- A specific reason for its adoption is not required
- Can be moved only in the **Lok Sabha**
- Moved against the entire Council of Ministers - if passed, the government falls

Censure Motion

- Reasons for its adoption must be stated
- Can be moved against an individual minister or a group of ministers
- Used for censuring the Council of Ministers or a Minister
- Can be moved only in the **Lok Sabha**
- If passed, the government does not fall

No-day-yet-named Motion

A motion for which a date has not been fixed, but which has been admitted by the Speaker for discussion, is called a No-day-yet-named Motion.

Point of Order

A Point of Order is raised when the rules of procedure are not being followed. No debate is allowed on a Point of Order.

Half-an-Hour Discussion

A matter of importance is discussed under this device.

Short Duration Discussion

This is a two-hour discussion. A matter can also be brought before the House through a Notice (in the Lok Sabha) or a Special Mention (in the Rajya Sabha).

Resolution

A Resolution is the resolve of the House. It may take three forms:

- Private Member Resolution
- Government Resolution
- Statutory Resolution - backed by law

Resolution vs Motion

Resolution	Motion
All resolutions are motions	Not all motions are resolutions
All resolutions are voted upon	Not all motions are voted upon

Prelims Practice Questions (PYQs)

Consider the following statements in respect of questions asked by the Members in the Parliament of India: (2026)

1. Unstarred questions are those to which a Member desires an oral answer in the House.
2. Starred questions are those to which a Member desires a written answer.
3. No supplementary question can be asked on an unstarred question.

Which one of the following conclusions based on the above statements is correct?

- (a) All the three statements are correct.
- (b) There are two correct statements, that include statement 2.
- (c) There is only one correct statement.
- (d) There is no correct statement

In the Parliament of India, the purpose of an adjournment motion is (2012)

- (a) to allow a discussion on a definite matter of urgent public importance
- (b) to let opposition members collect information from the ministers
- (c) to allow a reduction of specific amount in demand for grant
- (d) to postpone the proceedings to check the inappropriate or violent behaviour on the part of some members

Consider the following statements regarding a No-Confidence Motion in India: (2014)

1. There is no mention of a No-Confidence Motion in the Constitution of India.
2. A Motion of No-Confidence can be introduced in the Lok Sabha only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

The Parliament of India exercises control over the functions of the Council of Ministers through: (2017)

1. Adjournment motion
2. Question hour
3. Supplementary questions

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

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